

.mdz, .msc, .msi, .msp, .mst, .pcd, .pif, .prf, .reg, .scf, .scr, .sct, .shb, .shs, .url, .vb, .vbe, .vbs, .wsc, .wsf, .wsh.

Paranoia: Delete Them For Good

If you're paranoid, you won't be delighted to know that when you delete an item from Outlook, some parts of it may still be accessible from the .pst files (where Outlook stores data). Fortunately, there's a Registry hack to get around this problem. If it's a problem for you, that is.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Office\11.0\Outlook\PST

(Here, the "11.0" is for Office 2003; for Office XP and Office 2000, it's 10.0 and 9.0 respectively. However, the key doesn't exist on some Office 2003 installations, in which case you're better off not trying this hack.)

Create or modify the DWORD value called **PSTNullFreeOnClose**. Set it to **1** to purge deleted data. **0** is the default, but we recommend you change that post haste.

Log out of Windows and log back in for the change to take effect, but since you're paranoid enough to have applied this hack, a better idea would be to restart Windows.

Set A Dedicated Directory

Attachments that you open in Outlook have been saved in a pre-existing, known folder, whose names go something like "djj392u9d0dwh." This isn't gibberish; those folders have certain known names, and that fact makes for a potential security threat. Make a dedicated folder to save your attachments to before you view them.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Office\11.0\Outlook\Security